

EXPERIMENT NO. 2

Exploring Department Information Management with Zoho Creator

Name: Gayathri Boopathy

Roll Number: 240701141

1. Objective

To study how Zoho Creator can be used to construct a small information-management module through visual configuration. The experiment focuses on entering department details, viewing stored records, and presenting selected information through a dashboard.

2. Application Scenario

A department administration module is considered for the experiment. The module is intended to maintain basic information about organizational departments and provide a convenient way to review the stored entries.

3. Accessing the Creator Workspace

The basic setup can be completed through the following sequence:

- Open Zoho Creator and sign in to the account.
- Enter the application-building workspace.
- Select or create an application in which the department module will be maintained.
- Open the relevant form from the application navigation.

4. Department Entry Screen

The following screenshot is used as the visual reference for the data-entry component. It shows a Department form containing fields for Department Name, Department Head, and Department Location, followed by a Submit button.

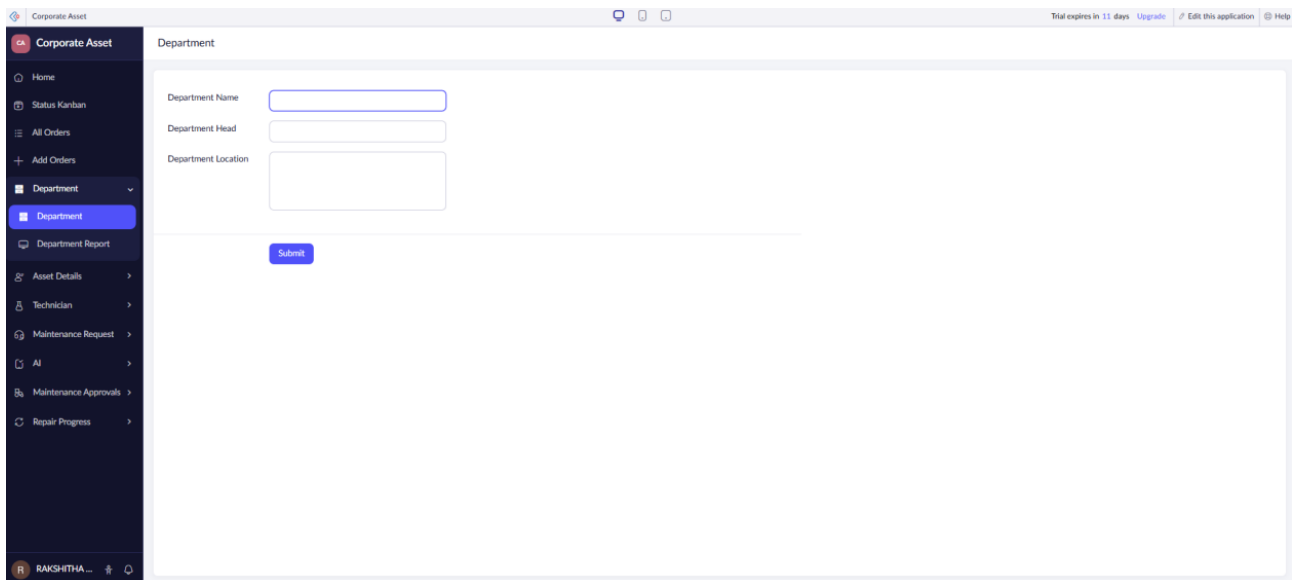
The screenshot displays the Zoho Creator interface for an application named 'Corporate Asset'. On the left is a dark sidebar with a navigation menu containing options like Home, Status Kanban, All Orders, Add Orders, Department (highlighted), Department Report, Asset Details, Technician, Maintenance Request, AI, Maintenance Approvals, and Repair Progress. The main area is titled 'Department' and contains three input fields: 'Department Name', 'Department Head', and 'Department Location'. Below these fields is a blue 'Submit' button. At the top right of the main area, there are links for 'Trial expires in 11 days', 'Upgrade', 'Edit this application', and 'Help'. The user's name 'RAKSHITHA...' is visible in the bottom left corner of the sidebar.

Figure 1: Department information form shown in the Zoho Creator application.

5. Form Interpretation

The displayed form represents a simple structured-entry interface. Department Name identifies the organizational unit, Department Head records the person responsible for it, and Department Location records where the department is situated. The Submit control is used to send the entered values to the application.

6. Organizing Submitted Information

Once department details have been entered, the stored information can be presented in a tabular report. A report is useful when several records need to be reviewed together rather than one record at a time.

7. Department Report

The second screenshot corresponds directly to the report component. It displays three sample department records and includes columns for Department ID, Department Name, Department Head, and Department Location.

Department ID	Department Name	Department Head	Department Location
3	Finance & Management	John	Block D
2	HR	Sidh	Block A
1	IT	Joe	Block C

Figure 2: Tabular department report containing three displayed records.

8. Reading the Report

The report provides a compact view of the information collected through the form. In the displayed sample, the records include Finance & Management, HR, and IT. Each row is associated with a department identifier, a department head, and a location.

9. Useful Operations on Records

The report layout can be used for:

- Locating a department record quickly.
- Comparing department names and responsible heads.
- Reviewing the locations associated with departments.
- Searching or sorting records when the application contains more entries.

This approach turns raw form submissions into an easier-to-read administrative view.

10. Dashboard-Based Monitoring

A dashboard can combine summary indicators and an existing report so that important information is visible from one screen. This is useful when an administrator needs an overview before opening individual records.

11. Dashboard Screen

The third screenshot shows a dashboard containing two prominent indicators and a Department Report below them. The visible indicators show a 15% region-performance value and 10 total visitors, while the lower section repeats the department records in a compact table.

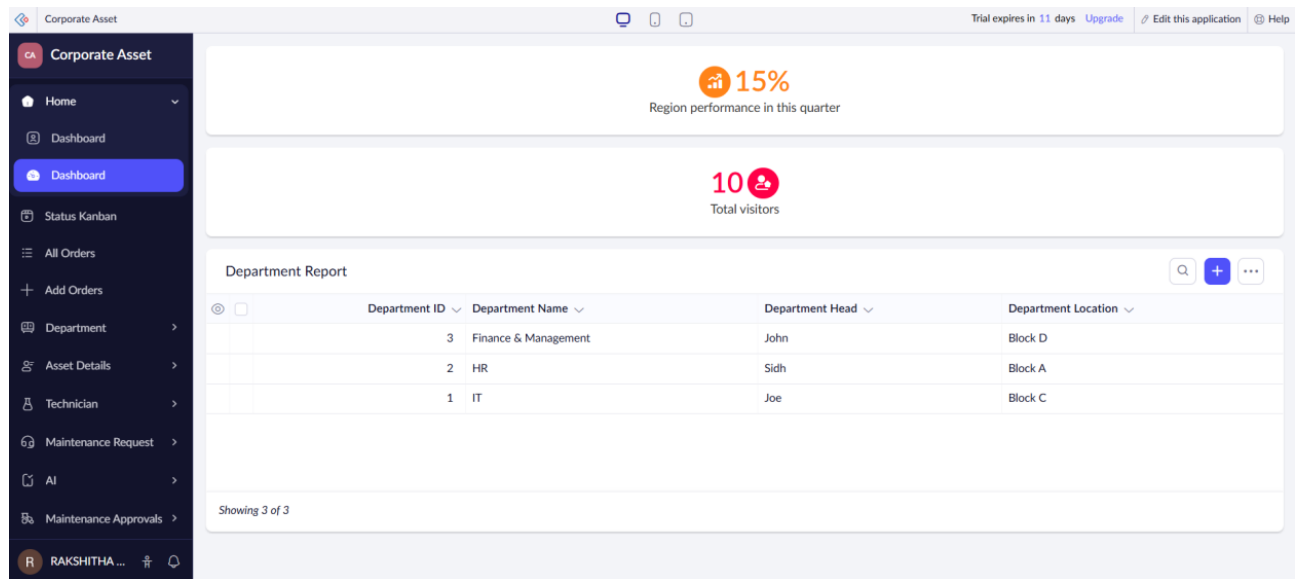


Figure 3: Dashboard combining summary indicators with the department report.

12. Interpreting the Dashboard

The dashboard demonstrates how different application elements can be brought together. The upper indicators provide quick numerical information, while the Department Report supplies the detailed records underneath. This arrangement reduces the need to navigate through several separate screens for routine monitoring.

13. Information Flow

Enter Department Details → Store Record → Display Report → Combine Summary Information → Monitor Through Dashboard

The flow shows how information moves from an input interface to an organized report and finally to a consolidated dashboard view.

14. Platform Features Examined

The experiment highlights several practical characteristics of a low-code environment:

- **Visual configuration:** Forms and application components can be arranged through the platform interface.
- **Structured data capture:** Separate fields can be used for clearly defined pieces of information.
- **Record presentation:** Submitted information can be exposed through a report instead of remaining as isolated entries.
- **Dashboard composition:** Summary indicators and reports can be placed together for faster monitoring.
- **Application navigation:** Different modules can be reached from the application's side navigation.

15. Advantages of the Approach

Using a low-code platform for this type of administrative application can reduce the amount of interface programming required. It also provides a structured path from data entry to record review and summary presentation. Changes to fields or views can be made within the application-building environment rather than implementing every screen manually.

16. Observation

The screenshots demonstrate a complete small-scale information flow: a Department form is used for input, the entered information is represented in a Department Report, and the same report is incorporated into a dashboard with summary indicators. Therefore, the experiment provides a practical view of how different low-code components can cooperate within one application.

17. Result

Thus, the basic department information-management workflow was explored using Zoho Creator. A structured input form, a tabular report, and a combined dashboard view were studied. The experiment demonstrated how a low-code platform can connect data collection, record organization, and visual monitoring with relatively little conventional programming.

18. Conclusion

The experiment provided practical exposure to building and reviewing an information-oriented application through a visual low-code environment. The corresponding screenshots show the relationship between the form, report, and dashboard stages of the application.